

NT32 Enrichment

†1. Elder Joseph Wirthlin's story of Elder Shaw and Mabiglia: "Elder Shaw had been in the mission field only two weeks when his senior companion became ill. The elders, as a consequence, had to remain in their apartment all day. Elder Shaw was moved by the Spirit and had a great desire to talk to someone about the gospel, so he picked up the phone book in which more than three million names were listed. He chose three. There was no response to the first call. To the second, a woman answered and informed Elder Shaw that she wasn't at all interested, and to make matters worse, declared that she couldn't understand his poor Italian and atrocious mode of speech. On the third try, a man answered. Elder Shaw introduced himself and received a warm response. The man said his name was Mabiglia and that he would gladly receive the elders. This he did. The appointment, made so miraculously, turned into a spiritually uplifting and inspiring occasion. After the first lesson, Mr. Mabiglia said, "How wonderful! I've worked for two years in a bank located on the street where the missionaries have done street-board tracting. Again and again I have practically brushed them as I passed them on the street, but I was too shy to respond to them. Now, in this miraculous way, I have met you." At this point we should change the "Mister" to "Brother," for after receiving the lessons, the man contacted by telephone was baptized, and Brother Mabiglia is now serving in the presidency of the Naples Branch." (["The Language of the Spirit," Ensign](#), November 1975.)

†2. Members criticizing Church Leaders: "The last category of criticism I will address comes from within the Church itself. This criticism is more lethal than that coming from non-members. The danger lies not in what may come from a member critic, but in the chance that we might become one.

"One activity which often leads a member to be critical is engaging in inappropriate intellectualism. While it would seem the search for and the discovery of truth should be the goal of all Latter-day Saints, it appears some get more satisfaction from trying to discover new uncertainties. I have friends who have literally spent their lives, thus far, trying to nail down every single intellectual loose end rather than accepting the witness of the Spirit and getting on with it. In doing so they are depriving themselves of a gold mine of beautiful truths which cannot be tapped by the mind alone...

"Inappropriate intellectualism sometimes leads one to testify that he knows the gospel is true but believes the Brethren are just a little out of touch...

"There are some of our members who practice selective obedience. A prophet is not one who displays a

smorgasbord of truth from which we are free to pick and choose. However, some members become critical and suggest the prophet should change the menu." (Glenn L. Pace, ["Follow the Prophet," Ensign](#), May 1989.)

†3. Demetrius a silversmith was terrified of Paul's success as it would diminish his business (Acts 19:26-27): "I wonder how many times in the history of the world the pocketbooks of men have intervened between their hearts and the manifestations of the Spirit. In a city in the state of São Paulo, Brazil, I taught the gospel to a man who owned a bar. He and his family were prepared and excited and, before long, baptized. During a visit not long after they joined the church, the father took me into an office in his business and said something like this. 'I have a problem. I make a living selling stuff that I do not believe people should use.'

"Not very long after, he sold his bar. Unable to find new employment for a while, he lived on the proceeds of the sale and spent his days working on the new chapel being constructed in his city. When the building was finished and a church reorganization occurred, he became the bishop of his ward. A few years later he became Stake President.

"He was a man unlike the silversmiths of Ephesus. He refused to let his silver impede his spirituality..." (Ted L. Gibbons, ["New Testament Lesson 32: 'Live in the Spirit'"](#); accessed 8/27/15.)

†4. Faith in Christ: "Suppose God had reduced all of the commandments of the Gospel to one command: "Thou shalt pull a train to the top of Mount Everest by thy own power." No need to repent or love or forgive or attend meetings or do our home and visiting teaching. Just pull the train to the top. We would all be on our way to the "dark and benighted dominions of Sheol," because none of us—not a single one—could ever comply. Perhaps if the ground sloped slightly downward in the beginning, the very strongest might move the train (if there were only a few cars) a few inches. But to the top? It could not happen. This is Paul's point. You will never be saved by living the law because you cannot live it well enough. Only the grace of Christ, only by the power of Christ, only by faith in Christ, can we ever hope to reach the top. Thus, "no man is justified by the law in the sight of God . . . for the just shall live by faith" (Gal 3:11).

"The purpose of the law was to be "our schoolmaster until Christ, that we might be justified by faith. But after faith is come, we are no longer under a schoolmaster" (Gal. 3:24,25, JST). (Ted L. Gibbons, ["New Testament Lesson 32: 'Live in the Spirit'"](#); accessed 8/27/15.)

†5. **Apostasy:** “We must walk in the Spirit, be led by the Spirit, live in the Spirit, and enjoy the fruits of the Spirit (see Gal. 5:16, 18, 22-25).

“CONCLUSION: Apostasy has not disappeared from among us. I have a letter in my possession written by a former colleague and Elders Quorum President. The letter contains a “revelation” calling me to the Quorum of the Twelve in his church, of which he is, according to his business card, “Prophet, Seer, and Revelator.” I have another friend, an associate of twenty years, who has turned from the sweetness of the revelations and living prophets back to the practice of polygamy. You all know of stories like these. They are tragic but they must be warnings to us to live in such a way and with such obedience that we can enjoy the companionship of the Holy Ghost, which will “show unto you all things what ye should do.” (2 Nephi 32:5). (Ted L. Gibbons, “[New Testament Lesson 32: ‘Live in the Spirit’](#)”; accessed 8/27/15.)

†6. **Paul’s Signature:** “The epistle would have been dictated to a secretary or scribe, but often the writer would add a signature and postscript in his own hand, as Paul did in Galatians. This begins at 6:11 and what he writes is significant: ‘**Ye see how large a letter I have written unto you with mine own hand.**’ “**A better translation of the Greek would be, ‘Ye see what large letters I made when I wrote to you in my own hand’**” (Ogden/Skinner, p. 167

“It seems that in the postscript, he wrote with exaggerated penmanship (as if in big letters, all caps, and underlined) to let them know how strong his feelings were on the matter. If Paul wanted to underscore the importance of this message for the Galatians, maybe we should evaluate whether we need to underline it today. Each Sabbath, each Sacrament meeting, each scripture study session, each temple visit, each home teaching assignment, each church calling, etc., etc., let’s think, “How can I use this ritual to raise myself to be closer to God?” The answer is always to do it in love, and to follow the direction of the Holy Ghost. That is the message of Galatians for the Latter-day Saints.” (Nancy Jensen, “[New Testament Lesson #32 ‘Live in the Spirit’](#)”, at LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus, accessed 8/27/15.)

†7. **Receiving the Spirit:** “What may appear initially to be a daunting task will be much easier to manage over time as you consistently strive to recognize and follow feelings prompted by the Spirit. Your confidence in the direction you receive from the Holy Ghost will also become stronger. I witness that as you gain experience and success in being guided by the Spirit, your confidence in the impressions you feel can become more certain than your dependence on what you see or hear.

“Spirituality yields two fruits. The first is inspiration to know what to do. The second is power, or the capacity

to do it. These two capacities come together. That’s why Nephi could say, “I will go and do the things which the Lord hath commanded.” 2 He knew the spiritual laws upon which inspiration and power are based. Yes, God answers prayer and gives us spiritual direction when we live obediently and exercise the required faith in Him.” (Elder Richard G. Scott, “[To Acquire Spiritual Guidance](#),” *Ensign*, November 2009)

†8. **Testimony like a flickering candle:** “Unfortunately, some in the Church may believe sincerely that their testimony is a raging bonfire when it really is little more than the faint flickering of a candle. Their faithfulness has more to do with habit than holiness, and their pursuit of personal righteousness almost always takes a back seat to their pursuit of personal interests and pleasure. With such a feeble light of testimony for protection, these travelers on life’s highways are easy prey for the wolves of the adversary.” (Elder Joseph B. Wirthlin, “[Spiritual Bonfires of Testimony](#),” *Ensign*, November 1992)

Recommended Reading:

1. Glenn L. Pace, “[Follow the Prophet](#),” *Ensign*, May 1989.
2. Nancy Jensen, “[New Testament Lesson #32 ‘Live in the Spirit’](#)”, at LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus, accessed 8/27/15.
3. Lenet H. Read, “[New Testament 32 Live in the Spirit](#),” accessed 8/29/15.
4. Gerald Smith, “[NTGDL32: ‘Live in the Spirit’](#)”, at Joel’s Monastery, 8/2/11.
5. BYU Studies, “[32. ‘Live in the Spirit’](#)”, accessed 8/29/15. Both the chart and the article linked here are worthwhile reading, studying, and pondering.
6. Bruce Satterfield, “[Lesson 32: ‘Live in the Spirit’](#),” at Meridian Magazine, 8/20/15.
7. Elder Joseph B. Wirthlin, “[Spiritual Bonfires of Testimony](#),” *Ensign*, November 1992.
8. Monte F. Shelley, “[NT 32: Faith or Works: Gospel Doctrine Lesson Notes](#),” 4 Sept 2011.
9. Elder Richard G. Scott, “[To Acquire Spiritual Guidance](#),” *Ensign*, November 2009,

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